



ADAM GRAY AFP/Getty Images

IMMIGRATION OPERATION IN NEW ORLEANS

A person is detained by U.S. Customs and Border Patrol and other federal law enforcement agents in New Orleans. A Homeland Security official says people accused of violent crimes are targets. **NATION, A4**

U.S. to slash fuel efficiency rules

Trump proposal could lead to more carbon emissions and pollution

BY TONY BRISCOE
AND HAYLEY SMITH

President Trump on Wednesday announced a proposal to weaken fuel economy rules for the auto industry, loosening pressure on automakers to control pollution from gasoline-powered cars and trucks.

The plan, expected to be finalized next year, would significantly reduce fuel efficiency standards for new vehicles in the 2031 model year.

At that time, the average

for new light-duty vehicles would be roughly 34.5 miles per gallon. Under President Biden, automakers would have been required to average about 50 mpg for light duty vehicles by 2031. That compares with about 39 mpg today.

The proposal could enable carmakers to manufacture and sell larger, heavier and less fuel-efficient vehicles across the country — including in California. Although the state has been allowed to regulate vehicle tailpipe emissions, it cannot

set fuel economy standards — the distance a car can drive on a gallon of fuel.

Under the Trump plan, vehicles are likely to produce more planet-warming carbon emissions and air pollution, making it increasingly difficult for California policymakers to reduce smog in Los Angeles and take action to stave off severe climate change.

In a news conference Wednesday, Trump joined several executives from Ford, General Motors and Stellantis in the Oval Office,

saying the proposal will allow car companies to produce more affordable cars and give consumers a broader choice of gas-powered models.

“Today, my administration is taking historic action to lower costs for American consumers, protect American auto jobs and make buying a car much more affordable for countless American families,” Trump said. “We’re officially terminating Joe Biden’s ridiculously burdensome, horrible ... stand-

[See Vehicles, A7]

Mother killed in '82; dad now held

Their daughter has suspected her father for years. D.A. says there's new evidence.

BY ANDREW J. CAMPA

For years, renowned epidemiologist Alison Galvani suspected that she had spent part of her childhood raised by a killer.

But nothing the Bay Area native did — not the private investigator she hired, the relatives and detectives she spoke with, the research she did independently — convinced authorities that there was sufficient evidence to arrest the man she believed responsible for the death of her mother, Nancy Galvani, in 1982.

That changed last week, when authorities took her father into custody.

The Police Department in Foster City, about 20 miles south of San Francisco, announced it had arrested 81-year-old Patrick Galvani without incident.

The San Mateo County district attorney's office charged him with murder Nov. 25. He is in custody in the Maguire Correctional Facility in Redwood City and is due back in court Friday.

Patrick Galvani's attorney, Douglas Horngrad, issued a statement saying his client “is innocent.”

“This murder charge was filed against him years ago and the case was dismissed for lack of evidence,” Horngrad wrote in an email. “As I understand it, the evidence is the same, and we believe the outcome will be the same. Mr. Galvani will be exonerated again.”

Dist. Atty. Stephen Wagstaffe said new evidence would be presented, but didn't elaborate on what

[See Galvani, A7]

Californians living under two different economies

BY LAURENCE DARMIENTO

California's economy has split between higher-growth areas, such as Los Angeles, benefiting from venture capital spending and other areas hard-hit by tariffs, uncertainty and the government crackdown on immigrant labor.

That's the finding of the winter UCLA Anderson Forecast released Wednesday, which predicts the state's economy as a whole will muddle through the coming months before growth picks up in the latter half of next year.

“California has now entered another bifurcated economy phase, not one between East and West, but one between AI, Aerospace, and the like, and the rest of the economy,” wrote Jerry Nickelsburg, senior economist with the forecast.

The report notes that in the first half of this year, nearly 70% of all U.S. venture

capital spending came to California, and in the third quarter seven of the top 10 investments nationwide were here.

Los Angeles and Orange counties in particular are benefiting from investment in aerospace and defense firms, and the Bay Area has been the recipient of artificial intelligence investments, Nickelsburg said in an interview.

However, Silicon Valley itself has experienced job losses, the report notes, amid a weakening demand for software engineers who code — a dynamic The Times has reported on as big tech firms cut payroll while they sharply raise their investments in AI.

It was initially estimated that AI-related capital expenditures would total \$250 billion this year, but already the amount has

[See Economy, A11]

Colombia a military target?

Threat of strike baffles longtime U.S. ally, unsure whether to take President Trump at his word

BY MICHAEL WILNER AND PATRICK J. McDONNELL



JOAQUIN SARMIENTO AFP/Getty Images

COLOMBIA'S leader has clashed with President Trump. In Cali, a girl poses for birthday photographs.

WASHINGTON — An offhand comment by President Trump threatening to attack Colombia, a major U.S. ally, has roiled its government and confounded its public, anxious and unsure whether to take the U.S. leader seriously.

Trump's remarks came during questions from reporters Tuesday over a prospective U.S. military campaign against drug trafficking networks in Latin America. The mission could expand beyond Venezuela, the prime target of nascent U.S. war plans, the president said.

“I hear Colombia, the country of Colombia, is making cocaine,” Trump said at a Cabinet meeting. “Then they sell us their cocaine. We appreciate that very much, but yeah, anybody that's doing that and selling it into our country is subject to attack. Not just Venezuela.”

Gustavo Petro, Colombia's first leftist president, who has repeatedly clashed with the White House, likened Trump's bellicose rhetoric to a declaration of war.

[See Colombia, A6]

Cuts could push thousands back to homelessness

14,500 L.A. County households could lose state, U.S. subsidies, erasing recent gains.

BY ANDREW KHOURI

Local officials are warning that more than 14,500 L.A. County formerly homeless households in subsidized, permanent housing could be forced back onto the streets or into shelters over the next year, mostly because of a loss of federal funding.

The predicted displacement would wipe away the slight reduction in the local homeless population since 2023 and is setting off a scramble by nonprofits and local government officials to try to blunt the potential effects.

“This is not a normal moment and we cannot treat it like it's a normal moment,” said Los Angeles City Councilwoman Nithya Raman, who chairs the council's housing and homelessness committee. “There is a potential for the entire homeless services system that we have built up here to fall

apart.”

The estimate that more than 14,500 households are now at risk of becoming homeless comes from the Los Angeles Homeless Services Authority, which did not say how many individuals could be affected.

About 3,500 of those households are at risk mostly because of state funding cuts, LAHSA said, and an additional 6,000 households could lose housing because a federal emergency housing voucher program, launched during the pandemic, is set to expire next year, four years ahead of schedule.

Between 5,000 and 7,000 additional households could become homeless because their rent in permanent homes is paid by a separate federal program known as continuum of care, LAHSA said.

Last month, the Trump administration announced it was slashing the amount that program would distribute for permanent housing and shift dollars to temporary housing options that mandate people enroll in services such as job training and mental health treatment.

[See Unhoused, A7]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

SHELTER resident Liliana Leyva has a Thanksgiving meal in her room with her children, ages 3 and 8.

Hegseth under increasing scrutiny

Defense chief put personnel, mission at risk with use of Signal, watchdog report finds.

BY LISA MASCARO
AND BEN FINLEY

WASHINGTON — The Pentagon's watchdog found that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth put U.S. personnel and their mission at risk when he used the Signal messaging app to convey sensitive information about a military strike against Yemen's Houthi militants, two people familiar with the findings said Wednesday.

Hegseth, however, has the ability to declassify material and the report did not find he did so improperly, according to one of the people familiar with the findings who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss the information. That person also said the report concluded that Hegseth violated Pentagon policy by using his personal device for official business, and it recommended

better training for all Pentagon officials.

Hegseth declined to sit for an interview with the Pentagon's inspector general but provided a written statement, that person said. The Defense secretary asserted that he was permitted to declassify information as he saw fit and communicated only details he thought would not endanger the mission.

The initial findings ramp up the pressure on the former Fox News Channel host after lawmakers had called for the independent inquiry into his use of the commercially available app.

Lawmakers also just opened investigations into a news report that a follow-up strike on an alleged drug-smuggling boat in the Caribbean Sea in September killed survivors after Hegseth issued a verbal order to “kill everybody.”

Hegseth defended the strike as emerging in the “fog of war,” saying he didn't see any survivors but also “didn't stick around” for the rest of the mission and that

[See Defense, A6]

Council rejects LAPD weapons ban
“Less lethal” projectile launchers are still dangerous and are misused, protesters say. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

These glasses can slow kids’ myopia
Lens approved by the FDA also could reduce the risk of glaucoma and blindness. **SCIENCE, A8**

Weather
Shine.
L.A. Basin: 72/47. **B6**

Markets A11
Opinion Voices A12

USC, UCLA haul in new recruits
Trojans’ football program focuses on locals; Bruins find a Sturdy Dozen. **SPORTS, B10**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.